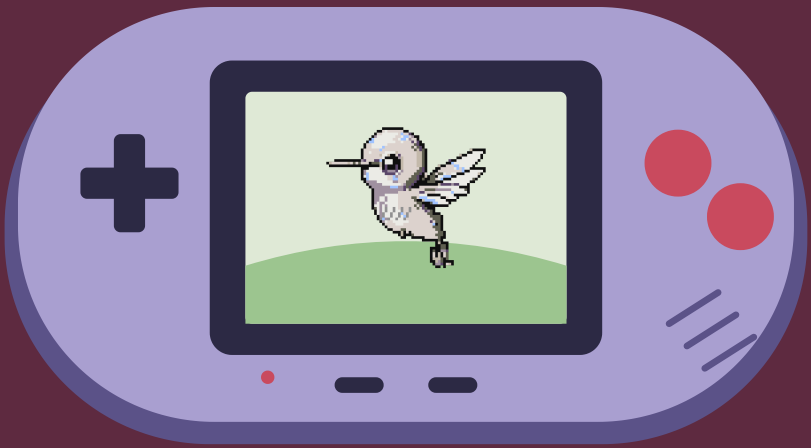
CONTEXT / CONTENT

# DAEMONS

## MICRO-START

*Five pages, and you are playing*





For release **v11.348.1**, 2026-11-11 · every word quoted from the game is a DRAFT
A fan project for the Game Boy Advance. No ROM is in it, or anywhere in DAEMONS.

CHAPTER 1

# What DAEMONS is

A game about a world where the machines came alive. They grew into creatures called **DAEMONS** (say it *DAY-mons*: an old Greek word for a guiding spirit, not the similarly spelt, frightening word that forked from it much later), and everyone you meet is an animal. You are a **USER**: you travel with DAEMONS, make friends with them, and keep a record of every one you meet, called the **INDEX**. Eight town leaders test you along the way; pass a test and you earn a **MARK**, like a badge.

The game never stops to explain itself: its stories are there for you to piece together, at your own pace. It comes in two editions, **CONTENT** and **CONTEXT** -- one story, told two ways. Somewhere in the world are two books to find and read, **THE PROGRAMMER'S GUIDE TO THE HUMAN MIND** and **THE SUBTLE LAYER**.

> *And some players whisper about a third.*

## Getting it going

DAEMONS is made by fans, so it is not sold in shops, and it is made from a copy of a game you own. **The first time, ask whoever gave you this to set it up.** Then:

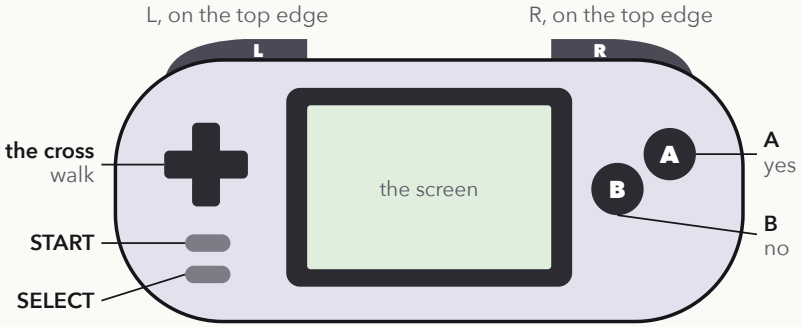
- **On an iPad or an iPhone**, open the DAEMONS app. On an iPad turned on its side, the game is on the left; on an iPhone, tap **GAME**. Touch the buttons drawn on the screen.
- **In a web browser**, open the playground address you were given, choose **CONTENT** or **CONTEXT**, and press **PLAY**. On a computer the arrow keys walk, **X** is A, **Z** is B and **Enter** is START.

CHAPTER 2

# The buttons

A means **yes**, and B means **no**. Everything else follows from that.

| button | what it does |
|---|---|
| the cross | walks you about; moves the pointer in a list |
| A | yes; talk to someone; read the next line |
| B | no; go back; close a menu |
| START | opens the menu: SAVE is in it |
| L R | help, outside a battle |




Where each one is, on a Game Boy Advance. On a phone or a tablet, they are drawn on the screen.

CHAPTER 3

# Playing

1. **Start.** Choose **NEW GAME**. CRYSTAL CLEAR, a scientist, says hello: press A after each line (a small red ▼ means there is more). She asks whether you follow **REASON** or **INSTINCT** -- there is no wrong answer -- and then your name.
2. **Walk and talk.** The cross walks; walk into a door to go through it. Face someone and press A to talk.
3. **Your first DAEMON.** In CRYSTAL CLEAR's lab, choose one of three. Any of them can go all the way.
4. **Battles.** In long grass, a wild DAEMON (the game says **UNBOUND**) may jump out. Choose **ROUTINES**, then a routine, with A. The green bar is health: empty theirs to win. **DETACH** runs away. A DAEMON whose bar empties has **HALTED**, and needs a rest.
5. **New friends.** Weaken a wild one, then choose **POOL** and offer it a **USERBOX**. If it stays in the box, it is yours: that is **BINDING**.
6. **Rest.** In a **CHECKPOINT**, talk at the counter and answer **YES**: every DAEMON is well again, free.
7. **Save.** Press START, choose **SAVE**, answer **YES**. The game never saves by itself. Next time, choose **CONTINUE**.



**LABEL**



**CLUSTER**



**ROVERCUB**

The three first DAEMONS: choose the one you like the look of.

CHAPTER 4

# Words, and where next

**BINDING** -- making friends with a wild DAEMON.

**CHECKPOINT** -- where DAEMONS rest, free.

**CONTENT, CONTEXT** -- the two editions.

**CRYSTAL CLEAR** -- the scientist who starts you off.

**DAEMON** -- a living machine creature.

**DETACH** -- run away from a battle.

**HALTED** -- out of health; needs a rest.

**INDEX** -- your record of every DAEMON met.

**MARK** -- earned from a town leader's test.

**POOL** -- your bag.

**RECOMPILE** -- a DAEMON growing into a new form.

**ROUTINE** -- something a DAEMON can do.

**THE REPO** -- the shop.

**UNBOUND** -- wild.

**USER** -- you.

**USERBOX** -- the box you offer a wild DAEMON.

## Where next

- **QUICK-START** (`DAEMONS-quickstart.pdf`): the same, in ten steps of a page each, in large type.
- **The player's manual** (`DAEMONS-manual.pdf`): everything, in full.
- **In the game**: press START and choose **HELP**.

For **v11.348.1** (2026-11-11), made by `tools/manual.py --book micro`.
Every word quoted from the game is a DRAFT. DAEMONS is a fan project, unaffiliated with and unendorsed by Nintendo, Creatures Inc. or GAME FREAK Inc.; Pokémon is their trademark. No ROM, and nothing of Nintendo's, is shared.